

Activity Type

Pairwork speaking activity

Language Focus

Complaining and apologizing

Aim

To make and deal with complaints.

Preparation

Make one copy of the two worksheets for each pair of students.

Level

Low intermediate

Time

25 minutes

Introduction

In this two-part role-play activity, students practice complaining and apologizing. In the activity, students get to play both the role of the person complaining and the role of the person who deals with the complaint.

Procedure

Divide the class into pairs (A and B).

Give each student a corresponding worksheet.

Ask the students to highlight the key ideas from the Fantastic Phones advertisement.

Read through the instructions for the first role-play with the class.

Go through the vocabulary on the worksheet and roles the students play.

Write an example dialogue on the board using the useful language from the worksheet and the students' ideas.

When the students are ready, they role-play a complaint about the misleading advertisement.

When they have finished, have the students highlight the key ideas from the second advertisement and repeat the same procedure as above.

When students have completed both complaints, have pairs present their role-plays to the class.

Note: This is an editable PDF. To edit the document, select the Edit PDF tool in Acrobat.

Student A**Fantastic
Phones**

All makes and models
are half price!

Quality guaranteed.

Full refund if you're
not
satisfied.

Our shop is close
to public
transport.

**Fly to New York
with Zoom Airways!**

Fly to the heart of
New York.

Tickets cost as little
as \$20.

Friendly staff.
Trouble-free boarding.

99% of our flights
arrive on time.

1. You bought a new mobile phone at Fantastic Phones. Complain to Student B about your experience and the misleading advertisement.

The phone you wanted was not discounted.

When you got home, you discovered that the phone was a fake.

When you called the phone shop, they said you couldn't get a refund because there was no damage to the phone.

There was no bus stop near the shop. You had to walk a mile from the bus stop to get there.

2. You work for Zoom Airways. Deal with Student B's complaint and apologize.

Useful language:

I'd like to make a complaint.

What's the matter? / What's wrong with it?

I'm sorry to hear that... / I'm sorry about that, but... / I do apologize.

I'm sure that we can sort it out.

Please tell me exactly what the problem is / what happened.

I'd like a refund / to get my money back.

Do you have a receipt?

Student B**Fantastic
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1. You work for Fantastic Phones. Deal with Student A's complaint and apologize.

2. You took a flight with Zoom Airways. Complain to Student A about your experience and the misleading advertisement.

The ticket cost \$20, but with taxes and extras the final price was \$79.

The plane took off one hour late.

You landed in an airport that was one hour outside of New York. It was late and there was no public transport.

You had to get a taxi, which cost more than the flight.

The airline staff were rude and there was no space to store your hand luggage.

Useful language:

I'd like to make a complaint.

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